

SSC Maharashtra Board — History and Political Science

March 2026 — Model Solutions

Time: 2 Hours

Max. Marks: 40

SECTION I — HISTORY

Q.1

Q.1 (A) Choose the correct option from the given options and complete the sentences: [3 Marks]

(1) The earliest museum in the world was discovered in the excavations at the city of ...

- (a) Delhi (b) Harappa (c) Ur (d) Kolkata

Ans: (c) Ur

(2) In Maharashtra, ... is supposed to be the first Keertankar.

- (a) Saint Dnyaneshwar (b) Saint Tukaram (c) Saint Namdev (d) Saint Eknath

Ans: (c) Saint Namdev

(3) It may be said that ... was the founder of modern historiography.

- (a) Voltaire (b) René Descartes (c) Leopold Ranké (d) Karl Marx

Ans: (a) Voltaire

Q.1 (B) Identify and write the wrong pair in the following sets: [3 Marks]

Set (1):

- (i) 'Prabhakar' — Acharya P.K. Atre
(ii) 'Darpan' — Balshastri Jambhekar
(iii) 'Deenbandhu' — Krishnarao Bhalekar
(iv) 'Kesari' — Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Wrong pair: (i) 'Prabhakar' — Acharya P.K. Atre

Set (2):

- (i) Balambhat Deodhar — Mallakhamb
- (ii) Khashaba Jadhav — Football
- (iii) Major Dhyan Chand — Hockey
- (iv) Sachin Tendulkar — Cricket

Wrong pair: (ii) Khashaba Jadhav — Football

Set (3):

- (i) Maharaja Sayajirao University — Delhi
- (ii) Banaras Hindu University — Varanasi
- (iii) Aligarh Muslim University — Aligarh
- (iv) Jivaji University — Gwalior

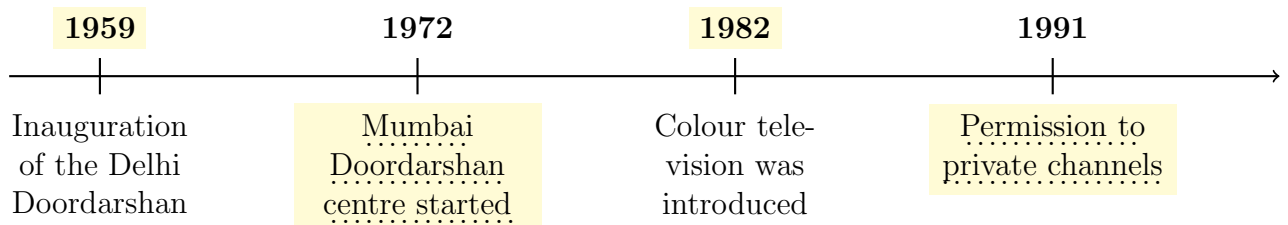
Wrong pair: (i) Maharaja Sayajirao University — Delhi

Q.2

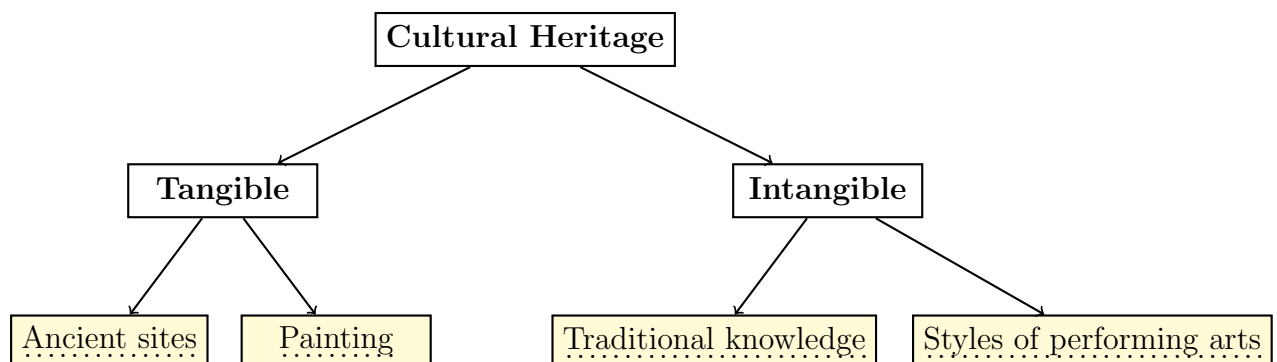
Q.2 (A) Complete the following activities (any *two*): [4 Marks]

(1) Complete the following timeline:

History of Television in India:



(2) Complete the following tree diagram:



(3) Complete the following table:

Sr. No.	World Famous Museums	Country
(i)	Louvre Museum	... France ...
(ii)	... British Museum ...	England
(iii)	Salarjang Museum	... India ...
(iv)	... National Museum of Natural History ...	United States of America

Q.2 (B) Write short notes (any *two*): [4 Marks]

(1) Nationalistic Historiography

1. Nationalistic historiography is a form of historical writing that **interprets past events from a patriotic or national perspective**. It emerged as a response to colonial historiography.
2. In India, during British rule, Indian historians like **V.K. Rajwade, R.G. Bhandarkar, and Vishwanath Kashinath Rajwade** wrote history to counter the British narrative that portrayed Indians as uncivilised.
3. The aim of nationalistic historiography was to **inspire pride in Indian culture, heritage, and freedom struggle**. It highlighted the achievements of Indian civilisation and the oppressive nature of colonial rule.
4. It played an important role in the **Indian independence movement** by awakening national consciousness among the people.
5. However, critics point out that nationalistic historiography sometimes led to **biased or one-sided** interpretation of historical events, overlooking complexities and regional diversities.

(2) Applied History

1. Applied History is a branch of historical studies that focuses on the **practical application of historical knowledge** to solve present-day problems and make future decisions.
2. Unlike traditional history that studies the past for its own sake, applied history uses historical methods and findings for **real-world purposes** in fields such as heritage management, tourism, media, law, and public policy.
3. **Heritage management** is a key area of applied history, where historical knowledge is used to identify, preserve, and manage cultural heritage sites and artefacts.
4. Applied history is also used in the **film and entertainment industry**, where historical research helps in creating historically accurate films, documentaries, and dramas.
5. In the field of **tourism**, applied history helps in developing heritage tourism by identifying historically important places and presenting them attractively to tourists.

6. It also finds application in **conflict resolution** and public policy, where lessons from history inform better governance and diplomatic decisions.

(3) Marco Polo

1. **Marco Polo** (1254–1324) was a famous Venetian (Italian) merchant, explorer, and travel writer.
 2. He is best known for his **extensive travels to Asia**, particularly to China, where he spent about 17 years in the court of the Mongol Emperor **Kublai Khan**.
 3. He started his journey in 1271 along the **Silk Route** and reached the court of Kublai Khan in China around 1275.
 4. Marco Polo's travel account, known as "**The Travels of Marco Polo**" (**Il Milione**), was written after his return to Italy. It provided Europeans with their first detailed description of the Far East, including China, India, Japan, and Southeast Asia.
 5. His accounts described the **wealth, culture, geography, and customs** of Asian countries, which greatly influenced European understanding of the East.
 6. His travels are considered a valuable **primary source** for historians studying medieval Asian history, trade routes, and cultural exchanges between East and West.
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Q.3

Q.3 Explain the following statements with reasons (any *two*): [4 Marks]

(1) An expert with deep understanding of art history is required in the art market.

1. The art market deals with buying and selling of artworks such as paintings, sculptures, and antiques. To determine the **authenticity and originality** of an artwork, an expert with deep knowledge of art history is essential.
 2. An art historian can identify whether a piece of art is **genuine or a forgery** by studying its style, technique, materials, and the period in which it was created.
 3. Knowledge of art history helps in understanding the **historical and cultural significance** of an artwork, which directly affects its market value.
 4. Art experts can provide proper **dating and attribution** of artworks to specific artists or art movements, which is crucial for pricing and trading in the art market.
- ∴ An expert with deep understanding of art history is required in the art market.

(2) Only trained persons who are duly qualified can take up the tasks involved in the work of conservation and preservation.

1. Conservation and preservation of heritage sites, artefacts, and historical documents require **specialised scientific knowledge and techniques** that only trained professionals possess.
2. Improper handling or use of wrong materials can cause **irreversible damage** to precious historical objects and monuments.
3. Trained conservators are equipped with knowledge of **chemistry, material science, and restoration techniques** needed to protect historical objects from deterioration.
4. They understand the **ethical principles** of conservation, such as maintaining the original character of the heritage object while ensuring its longevity.
5. Professional training ensures that conservators can **document and catalogue** heritage properly and apply internationally accepted standards of preservation.

∴ Only trained persons who are duly qualified can take up the tasks involved in the work of conservation and preservation.

(3) Historical research was driven to focus in depth on various aspects of women's life.

1. Traditional historiography was predominantly **male-centric** and focused on political and military history, largely ignoring the contributions and experiences of women.
2. With the rise of the **feminist movement** in the 20th century, historians began to recognise the need to study women's history as a distinct and important field.
3. Women played significant roles in various **social, economic, cultural, and political spheres** throughout history, which were previously undocumented or underrepresented.
4. The study of women's history revealed how **gender inequality, patriarchal norms, and discrimination** affected women's lives across different societies and time periods.
5. This research helped in creating a **more inclusive and complete understanding** of history by including the perspectives and experiences of half the population.

∴ Historical research was driven to focus in depth on various aspects of women's life.

(4) Expertise in history is important in the film industry.

1. Historical films and period dramas require **accurate portrayal of events, costumes, settings, and cultural practices** of the era being depicted.
2. A history expert helps the filmmakers in **researching and verifying historical facts**, ensuring that the film does not misrepresent or distort history.

3. Accurate historical content in films can serve as an **educational tool** for audiences, helping them learn about important events and personalities.
4. Historical inaccuracies in films can lead to **public controversy, legal issues, and loss of credibility** for the filmmakers.
5. Historians can advise on the use of appropriate **language, architecture, weapons, and social customs** of the historical period shown in the film.

∴ Expertise in history is important in the film industry.

Q.4

Q.4 Read the following passage and answer the questions: [4 Marks]

“Sohagaura Copper-plate: The copper-plate was found at Sohagaura (District Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh). It is supposed to be from the Mauryan period. The inscription on it is in Brahmi Script. The symbols known as ‘Tree-in-railing’ and ‘Mountain’ at the beginning of the inscription also occur on punch marked coins. Another symbol which looks like a structure erected on four pillars is supposed to be indicative of a granary. The inscription records a royal order that the grains stored in the granary should be distributed carefully. It is supposed to be suggestive of precautions taken in the times of a famine.”

(1) To which period does the Sohagaura copper-plate belong? [1 Mark]

The Sohagaura copper-plate belongs to the **Mauryan period**.

(2) What script do we find on the Sohagaura copper-plate? [1 Mark]

The script found on the Sohagaura copper-plate is **Brahmi Script**.

(3) Write the historical importance of Sohagaura copper-plate. [2 Marks]

The historical importance of the Sohagaura copper-plate is as follows:

1. The Sohagaura copper-plate is one of the **earliest known copper-plate inscriptions** in India, belonging to the Mauryan period. It provides important evidence of the **administrative system** of ancient India.
2. The inscription records a **royal order regarding distribution of grains** from a granary, which indicates that the Mauryan rulers had a well-organised system of **food storage and famine relief**.
3. The symbols on the copper-plate, such as ‘Tree-in-railing’ and ‘Mountain’, which also appear on **punch-marked coins**, help historians study the **economic and monetary history** of the Mauryan period.

4. It is written in **Brahmi script**, which confirms that Brahmi was the official script used during the Mauryan period and helps in understanding the **evolution of Indian scripts**.
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Q.5

Q.5 Answer the following questions in detail (any *two*): [6 Marks]

(1) Explain the characteristics of the Islamic Architecture in India with examples.

Ans:

Islamic architecture in India is a unique blend of Indian and Islamic architectural styles. It developed after the establishment of Muslim rule in India from the 12th century onwards.

Characteristics of Islamic Architecture in India:

1. **Arches and Domes:** Islamic architecture is characterised by the extensive use of arches (mehrab) and domes (gumbad). The use of the **true arch** and **dome** was introduced by Muslim rulers in India.
Example: The dome of the **Gol Gumbaz** in Bijapur is one of the largest domes in the world.
2. **Minarets:** Tall, slender towers called minarets are a distinctive feature. They were used for the call to prayer (azaan).
Example: The **Qutub Minar** in Delhi is the tallest brick minaret in the world (72.5 metres).
3. **Use of Calligraphy and Geometric Patterns:** Islamic architecture avoided the use of human or animal figures. Instead, **Quranic verses (calligraphy), floral motifs, and geometric patterns** were used for decoration.
Example: The walls of the **Taj Mahal** are decorated with exquisite calligraphy and floral inlay work (pietra dura).
4. **Use of Mortar (Lime and Cement):** Unlike earlier Indian architecture that used interlocking stones, Islamic builders used **lime mortar** as a binding material, which allowed for stronger and more durable constructions.
5. **Gardens (Charbagh):** Many Islamic buildings, especially tombs, were surrounded by **formal gardens** laid out in a symmetrical pattern called Charbagh (four-part garden).
Example: The gardens of the **Taj Mahal** and **Humayun's Tomb** follow the Charbagh pattern.
6. **Use of Red Sandstone and White Marble:** Mughal architecture extensively used **red sandstone and white marble** as building materials.
Example: The **Red Fort** in Delhi is built with red sandstone, while the **Taj Mahal** is made of white marble.

(2) Write about the history of Aakashvani.

Ans:

Aakashvani (All India Radio — AIR) is the national public radio broadcaster of India. It has a rich history spanning nearly a century.

1. **Early beginnings:** Radio broadcasting in India started in the 1920s. The first radio programme in India was broadcast by the **Bombay Radio Club** in **June 1923**.
2. **Indian Broadcasting Company:** In 1927, the **Indian Broadcasting Company (IBC)** was established, which started broadcasting from Bombay and Calcutta stations.
3. **Indian State Broadcasting Service:** After the IBC went into liquidation in 1930, the government took over broadcasting under the **Indian State Broadcasting Service** in 1930.
4. **All India Radio (AIR):** In 1936, the Indian State Broadcasting Service was renamed as **All India Radio (AIR)**.
5. **Aakashvani:** In 1957, All India Radio was given the name ‘**Aakashvani**’ (meaning ‘Voice from the Sky’). This name was originally coined by **Dr. M.V. Gopalaswamy** who had set up a private radio station in Mysore.
6. **Growth and Expansion:** After independence, Aakashvani expanded rapidly. It played a vital role in **education, entertainment, and information dissemination** across the country, especially in rural areas.
7. **Vividh Bharati:** In 1957, Aakashvani started **Vividh Bharati**, a commercial broadcasting service dedicated to entertainment, music, and film songs.
8. **Present status:** Today, Aakashvani is one of the **largest radio networks in the world**, with hundreds of stations covering nearly 99% of the country’s area and population. It broadcasts programmes in **23 languages and 179 dialects**.

(3) Explain the difference between indoor and outdoor games.

Ans:

Games and sports can be broadly classified into **indoor games** and **outdoor games** based on where they are played.

Sr. No.	Indoor Games	Outdoor Games
1	Indoor games are played inside a building, hall, or enclosed area .	Outdoor games are played in open grounds, fields, or stadiums .
2	They generally require less physical space and can be played in limited areas.	They require large open spaces like fields, grounds, courts, or tracks.
3	Indoor games usually involve less physical exertion and more mental skills.	Outdoor games involve vigorous physical activity and stamina.
4	Examples: Chess, Table Tennis, Carrom, Badminton (in indoor courts), Board games.	Examples: Cricket, Football, Hockey, Kabaddi, Athletics, Kho-Kho.
5	Indoor games are not affected by weather conditions like rain or extreme heat.	Outdoor games are dependent on weather and can be disrupted by rain, storms, or extreme temperatures.
6	The number of players is usually smaller (often 2–4 players).	Outdoor games often involve teams with larger numbers of players.

(4) What measures have to be taken for the conservation of the Heritage sites?

Ans:

Conservation of heritage sites is essential to protect our cultural and historical legacy for future generations. The following measures should be taken:

1. **Legal Protection:** Heritage sites should be protected by **strict laws and regulations**. In India, the **Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act (AMASR Act)** provides legal protection to heritage sites. UNESCO's **World Heritage Convention** also provides international protection.
2. **Regular Maintenance and Repair:** Heritage structures should undergo **regular inspection, cleaning, and repair work** to prevent deterioration caused by weathering, pollution, and natural disasters.
3. **Scientific Conservation Methods:** Modern **scientific techniques of conservation** such as chemical treatment, structural reinforcement, and climate control should be employed by trained professionals to preserve heritage sites.
4. **Preventing Encroachment:** **Buffer zones** should be established around heritage sites to prevent unauthorised construction and encroachment that may damage the site.

5. **Public Awareness:** Awareness campaigns should be conducted to educate people about the importance of heritage conservation. Local communities should be involved in heritage preservation.
6. **Documentation and Research:** Heritage sites should be properly **documented, photographed, and catalogued** for future reference and research. Digital documentation using 3D scanning and mapping is also important.
7. **Tourism Management:** While promoting **heritage tourism**, care must be taken to ensure that the flow of tourists does not cause damage to the heritage site. Carrying capacity should be determined and strictly followed.
8. **Funding:** Adequate **financial resources** should be allocated by the government for the conservation and restoration of heritage sites. Private partnerships and international funding can also be sought.

SECTION II — POLITICAL SCIENCE

Q.6

Q.6 Choose the correct option from the given options and complete the statements: [2 Marks]

(1) The power to make changes in the Constitution without altering the basic structure of the Constitution lies with ...

- (a) Parliament (b) Citizens (c) President (d) Vice-President

Ans: (a) Parliament

(2) To increase agricultural production and become self-sufficient with regard to food grains, ... was initiated.

- (a) Water revolution (b) Green revolution (c) Industrial revolution (d) White revolution

Ans: (b) Green revolution

Q.7

Q.7 State whether the following statements are true *or* false. Give reasons for your answers (any *two*): [4 Marks]

(1) Policy of reservation of seats is important for the establishment of social justice and equality.

True

Reason:

1. The policy of reservation provides representation and opportunities to **historically marginalised and disadvantaged communities** such as Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and Other Backward Classes (OBCs).
2. These communities were subjected to **centuries of social discrimination, untouchability, and inequality**. Reservation helps in correcting this historical injustice.
3. Reservation in education and employment ensures that members of disadvantaged groups get **equal access to opportunities**, leading to their social and economic upliftment.
4. The Indian Constitution (Articles 15, 16, and 46) provides for reservation to ensure **social justice and equality of opportunity** for all citizens.

∴ The policy of reservation of seats is important for the establishment of social justice and equality. The statement is **True**.

(2) The state government decides as to when and in how many stages the elections would be held in a particular state.

False

Reason:

1. It is not the state government but the **Election Commission of India** that decides when and in how many stages (phases) the elections would be held in a particular state.
2. The **Election Commission of India** is an independent constitutional body (Article 324) responsible for **superintendence, direction, and control** of all elections in India.
3. The Election Commission determines the **election schedule, polling dates, number of phases, model code of conduct**, and all other aspects of the electoral process.
4. The state government has no power to decide the election schedule; it must follow the decisions of the Election Commission.

∴ The statement is **False**. It is the **Election Commission of India**, not the state government, that decides the election schedule.

(3) People may lose confidence in the democratic process due to the corruption during elections.

True

Reason:

1. Corruption during elections, such as **vote buying, use of money and muscle power, and booth capturing**, undermines the integrity of the democratic process.
2. When elections are influenced by **corrupt practices**, the will of the people is not truly reflected in the election results. This leads to disillusionment among honest voters.
3. Corruption allows **undeserving candidates with money power** to win elections instead of deserving candidates, which reduces the quality of governance.
4. When people see that elections are **not free and fair**, they lose faith in the democratic system and may choose not to participate in the electoral process, leading to low voter turnout.

∴ People may lose confidence in the democratic process due to corruption during elections. The statement is **True**.

Q.8

Q.8 (A) Explain the following concepts (any *two*): [4 Marks]

(1) Regionalism

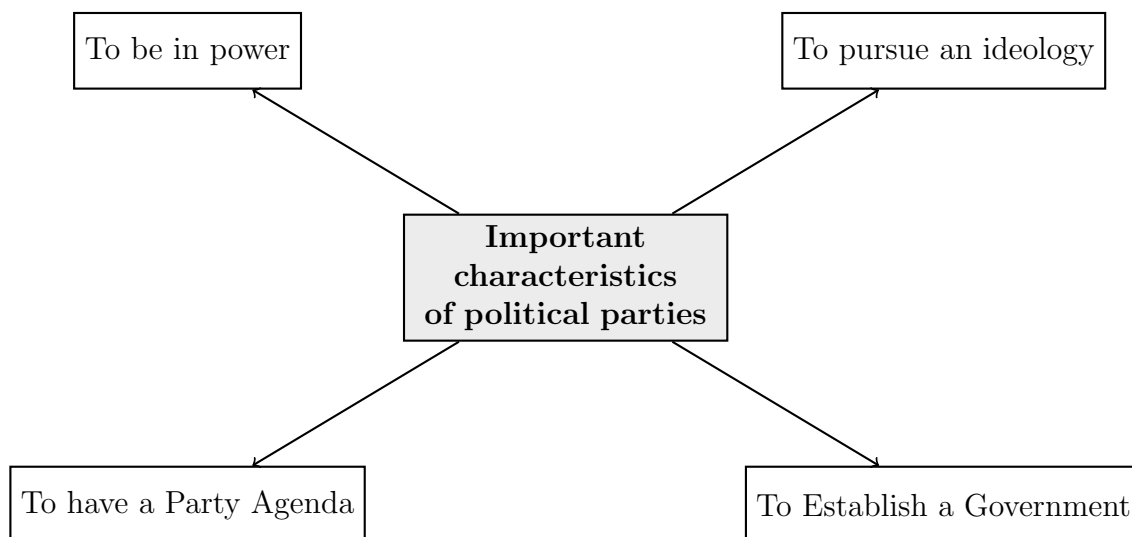
1. **Regionalism** refers to a strong attachment or loyalty towards a particular **region or state** within a country, often at the expense of national unity.
2. It arises when people of a particular region feel that their **language, culture, economic interests, or political aspirations** are being neglected or dominated by other regions.
3. Regionalism can manifest in demands for **separate statehood, greater autonomy, or special status** for a region. For example, the demand for separate Telangana state from Andhra Pradesh.
4. While healthy regionalism can promote **regional development and cultural preservation**, extreme regionalism can threaten **national unity and integrity** by creating divisions along regional lines.
5. The rise of **regional political parties** in Indian politics is a significant expression of regionalism. These parties focus on issues specific to their region.
6. The Indian Constitution provides for **federal structure with division of powers** between the centre and states to address regional aspirations while maintaining national unity.

(2) Women representation in the Lok Sabha

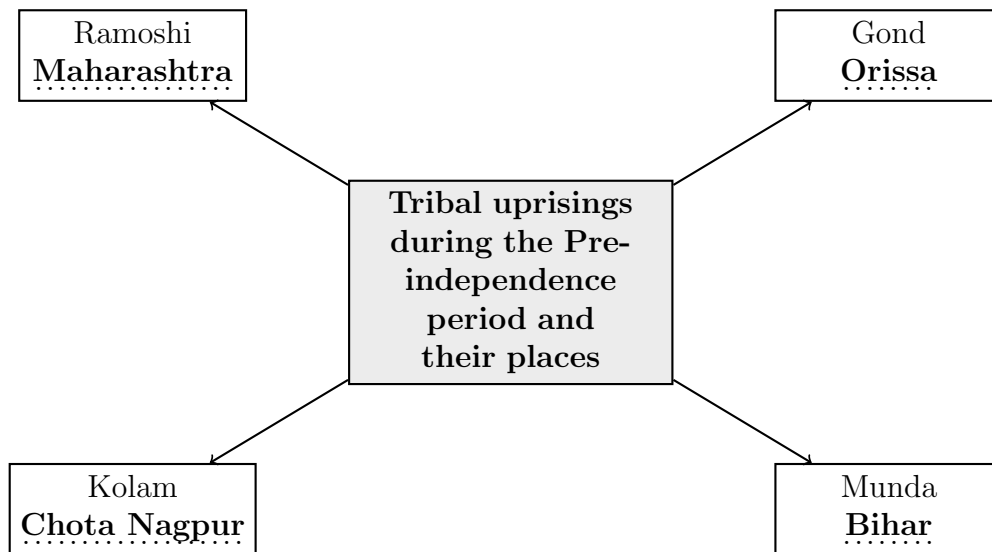
1. Women representation in the Lok Sabha refers to the **participation of women as elected members** in the lower house of the Indian Parliament.
2. Despite women constituting nearly **half the population** of India, their representation in the Lok Sabha has been historically **very low**.
3. In the first Lok Sabha (1952), only **22 women** (about 5%) were elected. The number has gradually increased over the decades but remains far below the ideal of equal representation.
4. To increase women's representation, the **Women's Reservation Bill (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam)** was passed in 2023, which reserves **one-third (33%) of seats** in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies for women.
5. Low representation of women is attributed to factors such as **patriarchal mindset, lack of financial resources, safety concerns, and dominance of male-centric political culture**.
6. Greater participation of women in politics is essential for **inclusive governance, better policy-making on issues affecting women**, and strengthening democracy.

Q.8 (B) Complete the following concept maps: [4 Marks]

(1) Complete the following concept map:



(2) Complete the following concept map:



Q.9

Q.9 Answer the following questions in brief (any *one*): [2 Marks]

(1) Explain the challenges in conducting free and fair elections.

Ans:

Conducting free and fair elections is essential for the functioning of a healthy democracy. However, the Election Commission of India faces several challenges:

1. **Use of money power:** Candidates and political parties spend huge amounts of money on election campaigns, far exceeding the legal limits. Vote buying and distribution of freebies to influence voters is a major challenge.
2. **Use of muscle power:** Use of violence, intimidation, and threats by candidates or their supporters to force voters to vote in their favour or to prevent opposition supporters from voting.
3. **Communal and caste-based appeals:** Some political parties and candidates try to **polarise voters on the basis of religion, caste, or language**, which undermines the democratic process.
4. **Misuse of government machinery:** The ruling party may misuse **government resources and officials** for election campaigning, giving them an unfair advantage over other parties.
5. **Fake news and misinformation:** The spread of **fake news through social media** during elections can mislead voters and influence their voting decisions.

(2) What efforts are undertaken to bring transparency in political process?

Ans:

Several efforts have been undertaken to bring transparency in the political process in India:

1. **Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005:** This act empowers citizens to **seek information from government bodies**, promoting transparency and accountability in governance.
 2. **Election Commission's role:** The **Election Commission of India** enforces the Model Code of Conduct during elections and monitors election expenditure to ensure fair elections.
 3. **Disclosure of assets:** All candidates contesting elections are required to **declare their criminal record, assets, and educational qualifications** through affidavits filed with the Election Commission.
 4. **Electoral bonds and funding transparency:** Measures have been taken to regulate **political party funding** and bring transparency in the financial dealings of political parties.
 5. **Use of EVMs and VVPATs:** The introduction of **Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs)** and **Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT)** has made the voting process more transparent and tamper-proof.
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